

SOCIOLOGY

Complete Coursebook

Terminale / Year 13 - 80 pages - Explanations in English

MAJOR THEMES

- Foundations & Sociological Theory
- Research Methods
- Culture & Socialization
- Family, Education, Religion & Health
- Work, Economy & Public Life
- Inequality & Stratification
- Deviance & Social Control
- Population, Urbanization & Environment
- Globalization, Media & Social Change

80-PAGE SOCIOLOGY RESOURCE

Concepts - theorists - comparisons - applications - exercises - revision

PURPOSE

This book introduces sociology as the systematic study of social relationships, institutions, inequality and social change. It combines classical theory with contemporary topics and emphasizes evidence, comparison and careful use of concepts.

HOW TO STUDY

- Read the guiding question before the explanation.
- Learn the key terms and use them in complete sentences.
- Connect individual experiences to social institutions.
- Compare theories instead of memorizing isolated names.
- Use examples from family, school, work, community and media.
- In research questions, distinguish evidence from opinion.

ASSESSMENT SKILLS

- Define accurately.
- Explain mechanisms and relationships.
- Compare perspectives using the same criteria.
- Apply a concept to a case.
- Evaluate evidence and limitations.
- Write conclusions that answer the question directly.

FOUNDATIONS - PAGES 5-12

- What Is Sociology?
- The Sociological Imagination
- Functionalism
- Conflict Perspectives
- Symbolic Interactionism
- Structure and Agency
- Micro, Meso and Macro Sociology
- Modernity and Social Change

RESEARCH METHODS - PAGES 13-20

- From Topic to Research Question
- Quantitative Research
- Qualitative Research
- Sampling and Representativeness
- Reliability and Validity
- Correlation, Causation and Confounding
- Research Ethics
- Mixed Methods and Triangulation

CULTURE & SOCIALIZATION - PAGES 21-28

- Culture, Values and Norms
- Language and Symbols
- Ethnocentrism and Cultural Relativism
- Agents of Socialization
- The Self and Identity
- Life Course Socialization
- Subcultures and Countercultures
- Culture, Power and Cultural Capital

INSTITUTIONS - PAGES 29-36

- Family as a Social Institution
- Marriage, Kinship and Household Diversity
- Education and Socialization
- Education and Inequality
- Religion and Social Cohesion
- Religion, Change and Secularization
- Health, Illness and Society
- Medicalization and Professional Authority

WORK & PUBLIC LIFE - PAGES 37-44

- Economy and Division of Labor
- Work, Alienation and Meaning
- Labor Markets and Unemployment
- Organizations and Bureaucracy
- Power and Authority
- State, Institutions and Civil Society
- Markets as Social Institutions
- Informal Economy and Livelihoods

INEQUALITY - PAGES 45-52

- Social Stratification
- Social Class
- Social Mobility
- Poverty and Social Exclusion
- Gender and Society
- Race and Ethnicity
- Intersectionality
- Age, Disability and Life Chances

DEVIANCE & CONTROL - PAGES 53-60

- Defining Deviance
- Durkheim, Anomie and Regulation
- Merton and Strain Theory
- Learning Deviance
- Labeling Theory
- Social Control
- Crime, Opportunity and Environment
- Punishment, Rehabilitation and Reintegration

POPULATION & ENVIRONMENT - PAGES 61-68

- Introduction to Demography
- Fertility and Family Change
- Mortality, Health and Population Aging
- Migration
- Urbanization
- Rural Communities and Rural Change
- Environment and Society
- Disaster, Risk and Resilience

GLOBAL & CONTEMPORARY - PAGES 69-76

- Globalization
- Media and Society
- Digital Society and the Digital Divide
- Social Movements
- Development and Social Change
- African Societies: Diversity and Change
- Madagascar: Community, Urbanization and Social Change
- The Future of Society

GUIDING QUESTION

How does sociology differ from common sense?

CORE EXPLANATION

Sociology studies patterned social relations, institutions and change. It moves from personal experiences to wider structures and asks how history, culture and power shape recurring outcomes.

- Connect individual experiences to wider institutions and historical conditions.
- Distinguish social patterns from isolated personal examples.
- Compare functionalist, conflict and interactionist perspectives before evaluating them.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Auguste Comte: argued for systematic study of society.
- C. Wright Mills: linked biography with history through the sociological imagination.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Personal trouble	individual experience	one worker loses a job
Public issue	pattern with structural causes	mass unemployment
Sociological inquiry	connects both levels	labor market and policy context

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

Why connect biography and history?

CORE EXPLANATION

The sociological imagination asks how private experiences are connected to institutions, historical changes and social positions. It protects analysis from blaming individuals for every patterned social outcome.

- Connect individual experiences to wider institutions and historical conditions.
- Distinguish social patterns from isolated personal examples.
- Compare functionalist, conflict and interactionist perspectives before evaluating them.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- C. Wright Mills: developed the idea of sociological imagination.
- Harriet Martineau: linked observation of everyday life with institutional analysis.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Biography	life history of a person	school-to-work transition
History	wider period and institutions	economic crisis or expansion
Connection	interaction of both	opportunities differ by generation

KEY TERMS

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GUIDING QUESTION

How can social institutions contribute to social order?

CORE EXPLANATION

Functionalism examines how institutions and norms contribute to coordination, continuity and integration. It also considers dysfunctions and unintended consequences rather than assuming every institution is beneficial.

- Connect individual experiences to wider institutions and historical conditions.
- Distinguish social patterns from isolated personal examples.
- Compare functionalist, conflict and interactionist perspectives before evaluating them.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Emile Durkheim: studied solidarity and social integration.
- Talcott Parsons: developed structural functional analysis.
- Robert Merton: distinguished manifest and latent functions.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Manifest function	intended recognized effect	school teaches literacy
Latent function	unintended effect	school builds peer networks
Dysfunction	effect disrupting a system	exclusion or overload

KEY TERMS

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GUIDING QUESTION

How does inequality shape social institutions?

CORE EXPLANATION

Conflict approaches examine how unequal resources and power shape institutions, interests and social change. They ask who benefits, who bears costs and how social arrangements are contested.

- Connect individual experiences to wider institutions and historical conditions.
- Distinguish social patterns from isolated personal examples.
- Compare functionalist, conflict and interactionist perspectives before evaluating them.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Karl Marx: analyzed class conflict and economic relations.
- Max Weber: expanded analysis to class, status and power.
- W. E. B. Du Bois: studied race, inequality and modern social life.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Class	economic position	ownership and employment
Status	social honor	prestige and recognition
Power	ability to influence outcomes	organizational or political influence

KEY TERMS

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GUIDING QUESTION

How are social meanings created in interaction?

CORE EXPLANATION

Interactionism studies how people interpret situations, use symbols and negotiate identities in everyday encounters. Large institutions are reproduced through many repeated interactions.

- Connect individual experiences to wider institutions and historical conditions.
- Distinguish social patterns from isolated personal examples.
- Compare functionalist, conflict and interactionist perspectives before evaluating them.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- George Herbert Mead: explained self through social interaction.
- Herbert Blumer: named symbolic interactionism.
- Erving Goffman: analyzed presentation of self in everyday life.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Symbol	shared sign or meaning	uniform or gesture
Definition of situation	interpretation guiding action	formal vs informal event
Role performance	enacting expectations	teacher, student, parent

KEY TERMS

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GUIDING QUESTION

Are people shaped by society or able to shape it?

CORE EXPLANATION

Sociology treats structure and agency as interconnected. Institutions shape available choices, while people interpret rules, resist expectations and sometimes transform institutions.

- Connect individual experiences to wider institutions and historical conditions.
- Distinguish social patterns from isolated personal examples.
- Compare functionalist, conflict and interactionist perspectives before evaluating them.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Anthony Giddens: described structure and agency as mutually produced.
- Pierre Bourdieu: linked social position with habitus and capital.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Structure	patterned constraints and resources	school rules
Agency	capacity to act	choosing a course
Interaction	actions can reproduce or alter structure	students form new organizations

KEY TERMS

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GUIDING QUESTION

Why study society at several levels?

CORE EXPLANATION

Micro sociology focuses on interaction, meso sociology on organizations and communities, and macro sociology on large institutions and long-term patterns. Strong explanations often connect all three.

- Connect individual experiences to wider institutions and historical conditions.
- Distinguish social patterns from isolated personal examples.
- Compare functionalist, conflict and interactionist perspectives before evaluating them.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Erving Goffman: micro analysis of encounters.
- Max Weber: linked action, organizations and historical change.
- Immanuel Wallerstein: analyzed large-scale global systems.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Micro	face-to-face interaction	classroom discussion
Meso	organization or community	school administration
Macro	societal or global pattern	national education system

KEY TERMS

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GUIDING QUESTION

What makes modern societies distinctive?

CORE EXPLANATION

Modernity is often associated with industrialization, urbanization, bureaucratic organization, mass education, expanded markets and rapid technological change. Sociologists debate both opportunities and social disruptions produced by these shifts.

- Connect individual experiences to wider institutions and historical conditions.
- Distinguish social patterns from isolated personal examples.
- Compare functionalist, conflict and interactionist perspectives before evaluating them.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Emile Durkheim: contrasted mechanical and organic solidarity.
- Max Weber: analyzed rationalization.
- Georg Simmel: studied urban and money-based social life.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Industrialization	factory and machine production	new labor relations
Urbanization	growth of cities	dense diverse interaction
Rationalization	formal calculation and rules	bureaucratic administration

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

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GUIDING QUESTION

What makes a sociological question researchable?

CORE EXPLANATION

A strong research question identifies a social phenomenon, population or setting and a relationship or process that can be investigated with evidence. It should be focused enough to guide method selection.

- Begin with a precise research question and define concepts operationally.
- Match the method to the question: surveys for patterns, qualitative methods for meanings, experiments for causal inference when feasible.
- Evaluate reliability, validity, representativeness and ethics.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Paul Lazarsfeld: advanced empirical social research.
- Robert K. Merton: linked theory and empirical research.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Topic	broad area	youth employment
Question	focused inquiry	how education affects job entry
Hypothesis	testable expectation	credentials increase hiring chances

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

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GUIDING QUESTION

When are numbers useful in sociology?

CORE EXPLANATION

Quantitative research represents social patterns numerically. It is useful for estimating prevalence, comparing groups and testing associations, but numbers depend on how concepts are measured.

- Begin with a precise research question and define concepts operationally.
- Match the method to the question: surveys for patterns, qualitative methods for meanings, experiments for causal inference when feasible.
- Evaluate reliability, validity, representativeness and ethics.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Adolphe Quetelet: early statistical study of social patterns.
- Paul Lazarsfeld: developed survey and quantitative methods.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Frequency	how often something occurs	employment rate
Association	variables vary together	education and income
Comparison	differences across groups	urban and rural respondents

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

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GUIDING QUESTION

Why study meanings and experiences in depth?

CORE EXPLANATION

Qualitative research investigates how people understand situations, construct identities and experience institutions. Interviews, observations and documents can reveal processes that standardized measures may miss.

- Begin with a precise research question and define concepts operationally.
- Match the method to the question: surveys for patterns, qualitative methods for meanings, experiments for causal inference when feasible.
- Evaluate reliability, validity, representativeness and ethics.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Howard Becker: used qualitative research on deviance and occupations.
- Annette Lareau: used intensive fieldwork to study family and inequality.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Interview	detailed accounts	work experience
Observation	behavior in context	classroom interaction
Ethnography	extended immersion	community or workplace study

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
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5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

How can a sample tell us about a population?

CORE EXPLANATION

Sampling selects cases from a population. Probability sampling supports statistical generalization when selection is well designed; nonprobability sampling can be valuable for hard-to-reach groups or exploratory research.

- Begin with a precise research question and define concepts operationally.
- Match the method to the question: surveys for patterns, qualitative methods for meanings, experiments for causal inference when feasible.
- Evaluate reliability, validity, representativeness and ethics.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Survey researchers: developed probability sampling and weighting techniques.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Random sample	known chance of selection	national survey
Purposive sample	selected for relevance	specialized occupation
Snowball sample	participants recruit others	hard-to-reach network

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

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GUIDING QUESTION

How do we judge measurement quality?

CORE EXPLANATION

Reliability concerns consistency; validity concerns whether a measure captures the intended concept. A measure can be reliable but invalid if it consistently measures the wrong thing.

- Begin with a precise research question and define concepts operationally.
- Match the method to the question: surveys for patterns, qualitative methods for meanings, experiments for causal inference when feasible.
- Evaluate reliability, validity, representativeness and ethics.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Methodologists: distinguish measurement consistency from conceptual accuracy.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Reliable	consistent result	same coding rules
Valid	captures intended concept	income measure reflects resources
Triangulated	supported by several sources	survey plus interviews

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

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GUIDING QUESTION

Why does association not automatically prove cause?

CORE EXPLANATION

Two variables can be correlated because one influences the other, because causation runs in the reverse direction, or because a third factor affects both. Causal claims require careful design and reasoning.

- Begin with a precise research question and define concepts operationally.
- Match the method to the question: surveys for patterns, qualitative methods for meanings, experiments for causal inference when feasible.
- Evaluate reliability, validity, representativeness and ethics.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Methodologists: use experiments, longitudinal data and statistical controls to strengthen causal inference.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Correlation	variables associated	study time and scores
Causation	one contributes to change	training improves skill
Confounder	third factor affects both	prior preparation

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

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GUIDING QUESTION

What obligations do sociologists have to participants?

CORE EXPLANATION

Ethical research protects participants from unnecessary harm and respects informed consent, privacy and voluntary participation. Researchers must also consider power differences and risks created by publication.

- Begin with a precise research question and define concepts operationally.
- Match the method to the question: surveys for patterns, qualitative methods for meanings, experiments for causal inference when feasible.
- Evaluate reliability, validity, representativeness and ethics.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Professional associations: develop ethical principles for social research.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Consent	informed voluntary agreement	participant understands study
Confidentiality	protect identity and data	remove identifiers
Risk minimization	reduce harm	avoid unsafe disclosure

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

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GUIDING QUESTION

Why combine methods?

CORE EXPLANATION

Mixed-methods research combines quantitative and qualitative evidence to answer complementary questions. Triangulation can reveal whether findings converge, differ by method or require a more complex interpretation.

- Begin with a precise research question and define concepts operationally.
- Match the method to the question: surveys for patterns, qualitative methods for meanings, experiments for causal inference when feasible.
- Evaluate reliability, validity, representativeness and ethics.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Contemporary sociologists: combine surveys, interviews, administrative data and observation.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Quantitative	breadth and pattern	survey estimates
Qualitative	depth and process	interview meanings
Combined	integrated explanation	pattern plus mechanism

KEY TERMS

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GUIDING QUESTION

How does culture organize social life?

CORE EXPLANATION

Culture includes shared meanings, symbols, knowledge, values and practices. Norms translate broad values into expectations for behavior, but cultures contain disagreement and variation.

- Culture is learned, shared and contested rather than biologically fixed.
- Socialization continues across the life course and occurs through multiple agents.
- Identity is shaped through interaction, institutions and social categories.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Clifford Geertz: emphasized interpretation of meaning.
- Emile Durkheim: studied collective representations.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Value	broad ideal	respect
Norm	behavioral expectation	greeting conventions
Symbol	carrier of meaning	flag, dress, language

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

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GUIDING QUESTION

Why are symbols central to society?

CORE EXPLANATION

Language and symbols make shared meaning possible. They classify experience, coordinate interaction and transmit knowledge across generations. Meanings can also shift across groups and contexts.

- Culture is learned, shared and contested rather than biologically fixed.
- Socialization continues across the life course and occurs through multiple agents.
- Identity is shaped through interaction, institutions and social categories.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- George Herbert Mead: linked symbols to social interaction.
- Erving Goffman: studied meanings in encounters.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Language	system of signs	spoken or written words
Gesture	embodied symbol	hand signal
Object	symbolic artifact	uniform or certificate

KEY TERMS

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GUIDING QUESTION

How should sociologists compare cultures?

CORE EXPLANATION

Ethnocentrism treats one culture as the standard for judging others. Cultural relativism asks researchers to interpret practices in context, while still allowing analysis of conflict, inequality and rights.

- Culture is learned, shared and contested rather than biologically fixed.
- Socialization continues across the life course and occurs through multiple agents.
- Identity is shaped through interaction, institutions and social categories.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Franz Boas: promoted historical and cultural contextualism.
- Ruth Benedict: studied variation across cultures.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Ethnocentrism	own culture as benchmark	calling unfamiliar customs inferior
Relativism	interpret in context	ask local meaning first
Critical analysis	study consequences and power	who benefits or is harmed

KEY TERMS

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GUIDING QUESTION

Who teaches people how to participate in society?

CORE EXPLANATION

Families, peers, schools, workplaces, religious organizations and media all contribute to socialization. Their messages can reinforce one another or conflict.

- Culture is learned, shared and contested rather than biologically fixed.
- Socialization continues across the life course and occurs through multiple agents.
- Identity is shaped through interaction, institutions and social categories.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- George Herbert Mead: explained role-taking and development of self.
- Charles Horton Cooley: described the looking-glass self.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Family	early routines and attachment	language and manners
School	formal and hidden curriculum	rules and credentials
Peers/media	identity and norms	style, language, aspirations

KEY TERMS

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GUIDING QUESTION

How does identity develop through interaction?

CORE EXPLANATION

Identity includes personal continuity and social categories. Interactionist theories emphasize how people imagine others' responses, take roles and present themselves differently across settings.

- Culture is learned, shared and contested rather than biologically fixed.
- Socialization continues across the life course and occurs through multiple agents.
- Identity is shaped through interaction, institutions and social categories.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Charles Horton Cooley: looking-glass self.
- George Herbert Mead: I, Me and generalized other.
- Erving Goffman: presentation of self.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Personal identity	sense of individual continuity	life story
Social identity	membership categories	occupation or nationality
Situated identity	role in a context	student in class

KEY TERMS

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GUIDING QUESTION

Does socialization stop after childhood?

CORE EXPLANATION

Socialization continues through transitions such as entering school, work, partnership, parenthood, migration and retirement. New settings can require resocialization and new role expectations.

- Culture is learned, shared and contested rather than biologically fixed.
- Socialization continues across the life course and occurs through multiple agents.
- Identity is shaped through interaction, institutions and social categories.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Life-course sociologists: study transitions, timing and linked lives.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Primary	early foundational learning	family childhood
Secondary	learning later roles	school and work
Resocialization	major change in expectations	new occupation or migration

KEY TERMS

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GUIDING QUESTION

Why do groups develop distinct cultural styles?

CORE EXPLANATION

Subcultures create distinctive meanings, practices and identities within a wider society. Countercultures more directly reject or challenge dominant values. Boundaries are often maintained through language, dress and shared activities.

- Culture is learned, shared and contested rather than biologically fixed.
- Socialization continues across the life course and occurs through multiple agents.
- Identity is shaped through interaction, institutions and social categories.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Dick Hebdige: analyzed youth style and subculture.
- Howard Becker: studied group cultures and deviance.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Subculture	distinctive within larger society	music community
Counterculture	challenges dominant values	alternative movement
Boundary marker	signals membership	dress or vocabulary

KEY TERMS

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GUIDING QUESTION

How can culture reproduce advantage?

CORE EXPLANATION

Cultural knowledge and styles are not valued equally in every institution. Bourdieu argued that cultural capital, habitus and social capital can help explain why some groups navigate schools and elite settings more easily.

- Culture is learned, shared and contested rather than biologically fixed.
- Socialization continues across the life course and occurs through multiple agents.
- Identity is shaped through interaction, institutions and social categories.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Pierre Bourdieu: developed concepts of habitus and multiple forms of capital.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Cultural capital	valued knowledge and style	academic language
Social capital	network resources	helpful contacts
Habitus	durable dispositions	sense of what is possible

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

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GUIDING QUESTION

What social functions and inequalities are organized through family?

CORE EXPLANATION

Families organize care, kinship, inheritance, emotional support and often economic cooperation. Family forms vary historically and cross-culturally, and household roles are shaped by gender, class and policy.

- Institutions coordinate recurring social needs through roles, rules and expectations.
- Institutional functions can coexist with conflict, inequality and unintended consequences.
- Formal rules and informal practices may differ.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Talcott Parsons: analyzed family roles in industrial society.
- Friedrich Engels: linked family forms with property relations.
- Contemporary family sociologists: study diversity of households and care.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Nuclear family	parents and children household	one common form
Extended family	wider kin network	multigenerational support
Household	people sharing residence	may or may not be kin

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
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5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

Why do family forms differ across societies?

CORE EXPLANATION

Marriage and kinship define social relationships, obligations and inheritance in varied ways. Sociology avoids assuming that one household form is universal or historically constant.

- Institutions coordinate recurring social needs through roles, rules and expectations.
- Institutional functions can coexist with conflict, inequality and unintended consequences.
- Formal rules and informal practices may differ.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Anthropological sociologists: compare kinship and household systems.
- Judith Stacey: studied family diversity and change.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Kinship	recognized family relation	descent or marriage
Marriage	socially recognized partnership	varied legal/cultural forms
Household	shared domestic unit	kin or non-kin

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

What does education do beyond teaching academic content?

CORE EXPLANATION

Schools transmit knowledge and credentials, socialize students into routines and expectations, and create peer networks. Sociologists also study how resources and tracking can produce unequal outcomes.

- Institutions coordinate recurring social needs through roles, rules and expectations.
- Institutional functions can coexist with conflict, inequality and unintended consequences.
- Formal rules and informal practices may differ.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Emile Durkheim: viewed education as moral and social integration.
- Pierre Bourdieu: studied cultural reproduction.
- James Coleman: studied educational opportunity and social capital.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Formal curriculum	official subjects	mathematics
Hidden curriculum	implicit routines and norms	punctuality
Credential	recognized qualification	diploma

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

Why do educational outcomes differ by social background?

CORE EXPLANATION

Differences in school resources, family resources, neighborhood conditions, expectations, language styles and institutional practices can combine to shape educational outcomes.

- Institutions coordinate recurring social needs through roles, rules and expectations.
- Institutional functions can coexist with conflict, inequality and unintended consequences.
- Formal rules and informal practices may differ.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Pierre Bourdieu: cultural capital and reproduction.
- Annette Lareau: family practices and institutional navigation.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Resource inequality	different material support	books or facilities
Cultural fit	institutional expectations	communication styles
Credential effect	qualifications shape opportunity	entry to higher education

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

How can religion create solidarity?

CORE EXPLANATION

Religious rituals, beliefs and communities can generate shared identity, moral meanings and social support. Their social effects depend on historical and institutional context.

- Institutions coordinate recurring social needs through roles, rules and expectations.
- Institutional functions can coexist with conflict, inequality and unintended consequences.
- Formal rules and informal practices may differ.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Emile Durkheim: linked ritual with collective solidarity.
- Max Weber: studied religious ideas and social change.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Belief	shared sacred meaning	doctrine
Ritual	repeated collective practice	ceremony
Community	organized social network	congregation

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

Does modernization always reduce religion?

CORE EXPLANATION

Secularization theories propose declines or transformations in religious authority, participation or institutional influence. Patterns vary substantially across societies, and religion can persist or change form rather than simply disappear.

- Institutions coordinate recurring social needs through roles, rules and expectations.
- Institutional functions can coexist with conflict, inequality and unintended consequences.
- Formal rules and informal practices may differ.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Max Weber: analyzed rationalization and disenchantment.
- Peter Berger: revised earlier secularization expectations.
- Jose Casanova: studied public religion.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Institutional decline	less formal religious authority	some public institutions
Privatization	religion becomes more personal	individual practice
Pluralization	more religious options	diverse communities

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

Why is health a sociological topic?

CORE EXPLANATION

Health is shaped by biology but also by income, work, housing, education, environment and access to care. Sociology studies how illness is experienced, classified and managed institutionally.

- Institutions coordinate recurring social needs through roles, rules and expectations.
- Institutional functions can coexist with conflict, inequality and unintended consequences.
- Formal rules and informal practices may differ.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Talcott Parsons: developed the sick-role concept.
- Michael Marmot: studied social gradients in health.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Social determinant	social condition affecting health	housing
Health inequality	patterned group difference	life expectancy gap
Sick role	social expectations around illness	temporary exemption and seeking care

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

How do conditions become defined as medical problems?

CORE EXPLANATION

Medicalization occurs when experiences previously treated as moral, legal or everyday issues are increasingly framed through diagnosis and treatment. This can provide care and recognition but can also expand professional authority.

- Institutions coordinate recurring social needs through roles, rules and expectations.
- Institutional functions can coexist with conflict, inequality and unintended consequences.
- Formal rules and informal practices may differ.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Peter Conrad: analyzed medicalization.
- Michel Foucault: studied knowledge, institutions and disciplinary power.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Medicalization	medical definition expands	behavior becomes diagnosis
Demedicalization	medical label weakens	category loses disease status
Professional authority	expert control over definitions	clinical classification

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

How does specialization change social relationships?

CORE EXPLANATION

The division of labor increases specialization and interdependence. Durkheim linked it with organic solidarity, while Marx emphasized how ownership and control shape class relations.

- Economic and public institutions organize resources, work, authority and collective decision-making.
- Formal organizations often rely on hierarchy, specialization and rules.
- Work can provide income, identity and solidarity while also producing inequality or alienation.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Emile Durkheim: division of labor and organic solidarity.
- Karl Marx: class relations in capitalist production.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Specialization	different tasks	occupational roles
Interdependence	reliance on others	complex supply chains
Class relation	economic power relation	worker and owner

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

Why can work be both meaningful and alienating?

CORE EXPLANATION

Work can provide income, identity, skill and community. It can also produce alienation when workers have little control over tasks, products, pace or purpose.

- Economic and public institutions organize resources, work, authority and collective decision-making.
- Formal organizations often rely on hierarchy, specialization and rules.
- Work can provide income, identity and solidarity while also producing inequality or alienation.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Karl Marx: analyzed alienated labor.
- Arlie Hochschild: studied emotional labor.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Task control	autonomy over work	self-directed pace
Product control	relation to output	craft vs fragmented task
Emotional labor	managing feelings for work	customer service

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

Why are jobs distributed unevenly?

CORE EXPLANATION

Labor markets connect workers and employers through credentials, skills, networks, location and institutional rules. Unemployment can reflect economic cycles, structural change, discrimination or mismatch rather than individual effort alone.

- Economic and public institutions organize resources, work, authority and collective decision-making.
- Formal organizations often rely on hierarchy, specialization and rules.
- Work can provide income, identity and solidarity while also producing inequality or alienation.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Economic sociologists: study institutions and networks in labor markets.
- Mark Granovetter: showed importance of social networks in job search.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Human capital	skills and education	training
Social capital	network resources	job referrals
Structural unemployment	jobs and skills mismatch	industry transformation

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

Why do modern societies rely on formal organizations?

CORE EXPLANATION

Bureaucracies coordinate large tasks through hierarchy, specialized roles, records and formal rules. They can increase predictability and efficiency while creating rigidity or distance from individual cases.

- Economic and public institutions organize resources, work, authority and collective decision-making.
- Formal organizations often rely on hierarchy, specialization and rules.
- Work can provide income, identity and solidarity while also producing inequality or alienation.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Max Weber: ideal type of bureaucracy and rationalization.
- Robert Merton: studied bureaucratic dysfunctions.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Hierarchy	ordered authority levels	managerial chain
Specialization	defined tasks	departmental roles
Formal rules	standard procedures	written policy

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

When is power accepted as legitimate?

CORE EXPLANATION

Power is the capacity to influence outcomes; authority is power regarded as legitimate. Weber distinguished traditional, charismatic and legal-rational bases of authority.

- Economic and public institutions organize resources, work, authority and collective decision-making.
- Formal organizations often rely on hierarchy, specialization and rules.
- Work can provide income, identity and solidarity while also producing inequality or alienation.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Max Weber: developed multidimensional theory of power and authority.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Traditional	legitimacy from custom	hereditary office
Charismatic	legitimacy from perceived exceptional qualities	movement leader
Legal-rational	legitimacy from rules and office	bureaucratic authority

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

How do state and civic organizations structure public life?

CORE EXPLANATION

Sociology studies the state as a set of institutions claiming authority over a territory, and civil society as associations and networks outside households and formal state administration. The relationship between them varies historically.

- Economic and public institutions organize resources, work, authority and collective decision-making.
- Formal organizations often rely on hierarchy, specialization and rules.
- Work can provide income, identity and solidarity while also producing inequality or alienation.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Max Weber: defined the modern state through legitimate physical force within territory.
- Alexis de Tocqueville: emphasized civic associations.
- Antonio Gramsci: analyzed civil society and hegemony.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
State	public authority institutions	administration and law
Civil society	voluntary associations	clubs, NGOs, unions
Market	exchange institutions	firms and trade

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

Are markets purely economic mechanisms?

CORE EXPLANATION

Markets depend on law, trust, norms, networks and organizations. Economic sociology studies how social relationships shape exchange, prices, information and opportunity.

- Economic and public institutions organize resources, work, authority and collective decision-making.
- Formal organizations often rely on hierarchy, specialization and rules.
- Work can provide income, identity and solidarity while also producing inequality or alienation.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Mark Granovetter: argued economic action is socially embedded.
- Viviana Zelizer: studied social meanings of money and exchange.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Embeddedness	economic action in social relations	repeat trading ties
Trust	expectation of reliability	credit relationship
Institutional rule	formal condition of exchange	contract law

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

Why is not all economic activity formally registered?

CORE EXPLANATION

Informal economic activity includes work and exchange outside full formal regulation or registration. It can provide livelihoods and flexibility while also exposing workers to insecurity and limited protection.

- Economic and public institutions organize resources, work, authority and collective decision-making.
- Formal organizations often rely on hierarchy, specialization and rules.
- Work can provide income, identity and solidarity while also producing inequality or alienation.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Development sociologists: study formal and informal livelihoods in changing economies.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Formal work	regulated and registered	contracted employment
Informal work	partly outside regulation	street trade or casual work
Livelihood strategy	combined income activities	farm plus market trade

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

How are societies organized into unequal layers?

CORE EXPLANATION

Stratification describes durable patterns in which groups have unequal access to resources, opportunities, prestige and power. Different systems vary in openness and the bases on which ranks are assigned.

- Stratification concerns patterned inequalities rather than isolated differences.
- Class, status, gender, race, ethnicity, age and other divisions can interact.
- Measure inequality through resources, opportunities, outcomes and power.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Karl Marx: class based on relation to production.
- Max Weber: class, status and power.
- Pierre Bourdieu: economic, cultural and social capital.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Class	economic resources and market position	income and ownership
Status	social honor	prestige
Power	influence over decisions	organizational authority

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

What makes a social class?

CORE EXPLANATION

Class can be measured through income, wealth, occupation, education and relation to production. Sociologists debate whether class should be treated mainly as economic position, life chances or a combination of resources and identities.

- Stratification concerns patterned inequalities rather than isolated differences.
- Class, status, gender, race, ethnicity, age and other divisions can interact.
- Measure inequality through resources, opportunities, outcomes and power.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Karl Marx: ownership and class conflict.
- Max Weber: market situation and life chances.
- Erik Olin Wright: refined class analysis for modern occupations.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Income	flow of earnings	salary
Wealth	stock of assets	land or savings
Occupation	labor-market position	professional or manual work

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

How do people move between social positions?

CORE EXPLANATION

Mobility can be intergenerational or intragenerational and upward or downward. Education, economic growth, family resources, networks and discrimination can all influence mobility.

- Stratification concerns patterned inequalities rather than isolated differences.
- Class, status, gender, race, ethnicity, age and other divisions can interact.
- Measure inequality through resources, opportunities, outcomes and power.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Pitirim Sorokin: early systematic analysis of social mobility.
- Contemporary mobility researchers: compare relative and absolute mobility.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Intergenerational	between parents and children	different occupational class
Intragenerational	within one career	promotion
Absolute mobility	overall structural movement	more professional jobs

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

How should poverty be understood sociologically?

CORE EXPLANATION

Poverty can be defined in absolute or relative terms. Social exclusion broadens attention to participation, housing, services, networks and institutional barriers.

- Stratification concerns patterned inequalities rather than isolated differences.
- Class, status, gender, race, ethnicity, age and other divisions can interact.
- Measure inequality through resources, opportunities, outcomes and power.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Peter Townsend: developed relative deprivation approach.
- Amartya Sen: emphasized capabilities and substantive freedoms.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Absolute poverty	basic-needs threshold	food and shelter
Relative poverty	resources below social norm	limited participation
Social exclusion	barriers to participation	services or networks

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

How are gender roles produced and changed?

CORE EXPLANATION

Gender refers to socially organized meanings, identities and expectations associated with sex categories. Sociologists examine household labor, education, work, representation and institutional rules without assuming one pattern is universal.

- Stratification concerns patterned inequalities rather than isolated differences.
- Class, status, gender, race, ethnicity, age and other divisions can interact.
- Measure inequality through resources, opportunities, outcomes and power.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Simone de Beauvoir: emphasized social becoming of gender.
- Raewyn Connell: studied gender order and masculinities.
- Judith Butler: analyzed performativity and repeated social practices.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Gender role	social expectation	care work norms
Gender institution	rules shaping opportunity	workplace practice
Gender identity	self-understanding	socially recognized identity

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

How are racial and ethnic categories socially constructed?

CORE EXPLANATION

Race and ethnicity are social categories shaped by history, institutions and identity. Racial classifications vary across societies, while ethnicity often emphasizes ancestry, culture, language or shared history.

- Stratification concerns patterned inequalities rather than isolated differences.
- Class, status, gender, race, ethnicity, age and other divisions can interact.
- Measure inequality through resources, opportunities, outcomes and power.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- W. E. B. Du Bois: analyzed race and modern inequality.
- Stuart Hall: studied identity and representation.
- Eduardo Bonilla-Silva: studied racialized social systems.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Race	social classification linked to perceived difference	historically changing categories
Ethnicity	shared culture or ancestry	language community
Racialization	process assigning racial meaning	institutional classification

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

Why analyze several social divisions together?

CORE EXPLANATION

Intersectionality examines how social divisions such as class, gender, race, ethnicity, age and disability can combine in ways that are not captured by studying each category separately.

- Stratification concerns patterned inequalities rather than isolated differences.
- Class, status, gender, race, ethnicity, age and other divisions can interact.
- Measure inequality through resources, opportunities, outcomes and power.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Kimberle Crenshaw: developed intersectionality in legal and social analysis.
- Patricia Hill Collins: analyzed intersecting systems of power.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Single-axis view	one category at a time	class only
Intersectional view	combined positions	class and gender together
Institutional effect	rules affect combinations differently	hiring or access

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

How do age and disability shape social opportunity?

CORE EXPLANATION

Age and disability interact with institutions, infrastructure, labor markets and cultural expectations. Sociological analysis distinguishes bodily variation from barriers created by social organization.

- Stratification concerns patterned inequalities rather than isolated differences.
- Class, status, gender, race, ethnicity, age and other divisions can interact.
- Measure inequality through resources, opportunities, outcomes and power.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Disability sociologists: contrast medical and social models of disability.
- Life-course researchers: study age-linked transitions and institutions.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Medical model	focus on impairment	treatment need
Social model	focus on barriers	inaccessible design
Life-course effect	timing and transition	retirement or schooling

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

Who decides what counts as deviant?

CORE EXPLANATION

Deviance is behavior or identity defined as violating norms. Because norms vary across time, place and groups, the same act can be treated differently in different contexts.

- Deviance depends on social rules and reactions as well as behavior itself.
- Different theories emphasize social integration, strain, learning, labeling, power or opportunity.
- Formal control includes law and institutions; informal control includes families, peers and communities.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Emile Durkheim: argued deviance is normal in all societies.
- Howard Becker: emphasized social reaction and labeling.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Norm violation	breaks expectation	context-specific behavior
Deviant label	social reaction	outsider designation
Crime	legal category	law-prohibited act

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

How can weak regulation contribute to deviance?

CORE EXPLANATION

Durkheim used anomie to describe weakened normative regulation. Later theories applied similar ideas to contexts where social expectations and available means are misaligned.

- Deviance depends on social rules and reactions as well as behavior itself.
- Different theories emphasize social integration, strain, learning, labeling, power or opportunity.
- Formal control includes law and institutions; informal control includes families, peers and communities.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Emile Durkheim: anomie and social regulation.
- Robert Merton: adapted anomie into strain theory.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Integration	strength of social ties	community attachment
Regulation	clarity of norms	stable expectations
Anomie	weakened regulation	rapid disruption

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

What happens when goals and opportunities do not align?

CORE EXPLANATION

Merton argued that strain can arise when societies emphasize valued goals but access to legitimate means is unequal. People may respond through conformity, innovation, ritualism, retreatism or rebellion.

- Deviance depends on social rules and reactions as well as behavior itself.
- Different theories emphasize social integration, strain, learning, labeling, power or opportunity.
- Formal control includes law and institutions; informal control includes families, peers and communities.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Robert K. Merton: developed strain theory.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Conformity	accept goals and means	conventional route
Innovation	accept goals, use alternative means	rule-breaking strategy
Retreatism	withdraw from both	social withdrawal

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

Can deviance be learned socially?

CORE EXPLANATION

Differential association theory proposes that definitions favorable to rule-breaking can be learned through interaction. The theory shifts attention from individual traits to social networks and learned techniques.

- Deviance depends on social rules and reactions as well as behavior itself.
- Different theories emphasize social integration, strain, learning, labeling, power or opportunity.
- Formal control includes law and institutions; informal control includes families, peers and communities.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Edwin Sutherland: developed differential association theory.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Association	interaction network	peer group
Definition	attitude toward rules	justification
Technique	learned practice	how behavior is carried out

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

How can social reaction shape deviant identity?

CORE EXPLANATION

Labeling theory studies how authorities and communities classify behavior and people. A label can alter opportunities, identity and future interactions, especially when stigma becomes difficult to escape.

- Deviance depends on social rules and reactions as well as behavior itself.
- Different theories emphasize social integration, strain, learning, labeling, power or opportunity.
- Formal control includes law and institutions; informal control includes families, peers and communities.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Howard Becker: outsiders and labeling.
- Edwin Lemert: primary and secondary deviance.
- Erving Goffman: stigma and spoiled identity.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Primary deviance	initial rule-breaking	limited identity effect
Secondary deviance	behavior after label becomes central	identity transformation
Stigma	discrediting attribute	reduced opportunity

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

How do societies encourage conformity?

CORE EXPLANATION

Social control includes informal mechanisms such as approval, shame and peer pressure and formal mechanisms such as law, schools and organizational rules. Control can maintain order while also reflecting unequal power.

- Deviance depends on social rules and reactions as well as behavior itself.
- Different theories emphasize social integration, strain, learning, labeling, power or opportunity.
- Formal control includes law and institutions; informal control includes families, peers and communities.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Travis Hirschi: studied social bonds and conformity.
- Michel Foucault: analyzed discipline and surveillance.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Informal control	social approval or disapproval	family reaction
Formal control	codified rules and sanctions	law or school discipline
Self-regulation	internalized norms	guilt or responsibility

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

Why do crime patterns vary across places?

CORE EXPLANATION

Opportunity theories examine how routine activities, guardianship, targets and neighborhood conditions shape where offenses are more likely to occur. They complement rather than replace explanations of motivation and inequality.

- Deviance depends on social rules and reactions as well as behavior itself.
- Different theories emphasize social integration, strain, learning, labeling, power or opportunity.
- Formal control includes law and institutions; informal control includes families, peers and communities.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Lawrence Cohen and Marcus Felson: routine activity theory.
- Chicago School researchers: studied neighborhood social organization.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Target	object or person exposed to risk	unsecured property
Guardianship	protective presence	neighbors or security
Routine activity	regular movement pattern	commuting or shopping

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

What are the social purposes of punishment?

CORE EXPLANATION

Punishment systems can pursue deterrence, incapacitation, retribution, rehabilitation and reintegration. Sociologists ask how these goals are balanced and how sanctions affect families, communities and future opportunity.

- Deviance depends on social rules and reactions as well as behavior itself.
- Different theories emphasize social integration, strain, learning, labeling, power or opportunity.
- Formal control includes law and institutions; informal control includes families, peers and communities.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Emile Durkheim: linked punishment with moral boundaries.
- Michel Foucault: studied historical changes in punishment.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Deterrence	discourage future offense	threat of sanction
Rehabilitation	support behavior change	education or treatment
Reintegration	restore social participation	employment and community support

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

How do sociologists study population change?

CORE EXPLANATION

Demography examines population size, age structure, fertility, mortality and migration. These processes influence schools, labor markets, housing, health systems and family life.

- Population change results from fertility, mortality and migration.
- Urbanization reorganizes work, housing, infrastructure and social interaction.
- Environmental risks are socially distributed and managed through institutions.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Thomas Malthus: early population-resource argument.
- Modern demographers: use census and survey data to model population change.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Fertility	birth patterns	birth rate
Mortality	death patterns	life expectancy
Migration	movement of residence	internal or international

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

Why do fertility patterns change?

CORE EXPLANATION

Fertility is influenced by education, health, child survival, employment, gender relations, housing, cultural expectations and access to family planning. No single factor explains every society.

- Population change results from fertility, mortality and migration.
- Urbanization reorganizes work, housing, infrastructure and social interaction.
- Environmental risks are socially distributed and managed through institutions.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Demographic transition researchers: study changing birth and death rates.
- Family sociologists: link fertility to institutions and gender relations.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
High fertility context	more births per woman	varied causes
Fertility decline	smaller family size	education and urbanization often matter
Delayed fertility	later first birth	longer education or work entry

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

Why do populations age?

CORE EXPLANATION

Population aging occurs when fertility declines and survival improves. Aging changes household care, pensions, health services and labor-force composition.

- Population change results from fertility, mortality and migration.
- Urbanization reorganizes work, housing, infrastructure and social interaction.
- Environmental risks are socially distributed and managed through institutions.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Demographers: analyze age structure and life expectancy.
- Life-course sociologists: study institutions across stages of life.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Life expectancy	average years of life under current rates	population indicator
Dependency ratio	age-based population comparison	working-age vs dependents
Population aging	larger older share	service implications

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

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3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

Why do people migrate?

CORE EXPLANATION

Migration reflects combinations of work, education, family, safety, environment and aspiration. Networks can reduce the costs and risks of movement by providing information and support.

- Population change results from fertility, mortality and migration.
- Urbanization reorganizes work, housing, infrastructure and social interaction.
- Environmental risks are socially distributed and managed through institutions.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Everett Lee: push-pull framework.
- Douglas Massey: migration networks and cumulative causation.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Push factor	condition encouraging departure	limited jobs
Pull factor	attraction of destination	education opportunity
Network effect	contacts facilitate movement	housing information

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

How does city growth transform social life?

CORE EXPLANATION

Urbanization concentrates population, jobs, services and infrastructure. Cities can increase opportunity and diversity while also producing congestion, housing pressure and spatial inequality.

- Population change results from fertility, mortality and migration.
- Urbanization reorganizes work, housing, infrastructure and social interaction.
- Environmental risks are socially distributed and managed through institutions.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Georg Simmel: urban experience and social interaction.
- Louis Wirth: urbanism as a way of life.
- Manuel Castells: urban networks and social movements.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Density	people concentrated in space	apartment districts
Diversity	heterogeneous population	multiple occupations
Segregation	spatial separation of groups	unequal neighborhoods

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

How do rural societies change under modernization?

CORE EXPLANATION

Rural communities are shaped by agriculture, land, transport, markets, migration and public services. Rural change can include commercialization, mechanization, out-migration and new digital connections.

- Population change results from fertility, mortality and migration.
- Urbanization reorganizes work, housing, infrastructure and social interaction.
- Environmental risks are socially distributed and managed through institutions.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Rural sociologists: study communities, agriculture and land relations.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Agrarian livelihood	land-based production	farming
Rural-urban link	flows of people and goods	market migration
Diversification	multiple income sources	farm plus services

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

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4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

Why are environmental problems social as well as natural?

CORE EXPLANATION

Environmental outcomes depend on production, consumption, technology, regulation and unequal exposure to risk. Sociology studies how institutions define, distribute and respond to environmental problems.

- Population change results from fertility, mortality and migration.
- Urbanization reorganizes work, housing, infrastructure and social interaction.
- Environmental risks are socially distributed and managed through institutions.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Ulrich Beck: risk society.
- Allan Schnaiberg: treadmill of production perspective.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Environmental risk	hazard with social distribution	pollution exposure
Regulation	collective rules	waste standards
Sustainability	long-term social-environmental viability	resource management

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

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GUIDING QUESTION

Why do similar hazards affect communities differently?

CORE EXPLANATION

A hazard becomes a social disaster through exposure, vulnerability and institutional capacity. Housing quality, infrastructure, poverty and communication can influence who is most affected and how quickly recovery occurs.

- Population change results from fertility, mortality and migration.
- Urbanization reorganizes work, housing, infrastructure and social interaction.
- Environmental risks are socially distributed and managed through institutions.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Disaster sociologists: distinguish physical hazard from socially produced vulnerability.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Hazard	potential damaging event	cyclone
Vulnerability	susceptibility to harm	weak housing
Resilience	capacity to adapt and recover	networks and services

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

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3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

How does globalization reshape social life?

CORE EXPLANATION

Globalization refers to intensified cross-border flows of goods, people, capital, media and ideas. It can create opportunities for exchange while also producing uneven dependence and exposure to distant events.

- Globalization links local life to transnational flows of goods, people, information and institutions.
- Media and digital technologies can expand connection while reproducing inequalities.
- Social movements mobilize identities, networks and resources around claims for change.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Anthony Giddens: time-space distancing and modernity.
- Saskia Sassen: global cities and transnational processes.
- Arjun Appadurai: global cultural flows.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Economic flow	trade and capital	global supply chain
Human flow	migration and travel	labor mobility
Cultural flow	media and ideas	music and language

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
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3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

How do media shape social reality?

CORE EXPLANATION

Media select, frame and circulate information. Audiences are active interpreters, but ownership, algorithms, professional routines and platform design influence which messages become visible.

- Globalization links local life to transnational flows of goods, people, information and institutions.
- Media and digital technologies can expand connection while reproducing inequalities.
- Social movements mobilize identities, networks and resources around claims for change.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Marshall McLuhan: studied media forms and social change.
- Stuart Hall: encoding/decoding and representation.
- Pierre Bourdieu: studied fields and media power.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Representation	how groups/issues are portrayed	news frame
Gatekeeping	selection of content	editorial decision
Audience interpretation	meaning made by users	different readings

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
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3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

Do digital technologies reduce or reproduce inequality?

CORE EXPLANATION

Digital technologies expand communication, learning and economic activity, but access, skills, language, device quality and connectivity are unequal. Benefits therefore depend on social conditions.

- Globalization links local life to transnational flows of goods, people, information and institutions.
- Media and digital technologies can expand connection while reproducing inequalities.
- Social movements mobilize identities, networks and resources around claims for change.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Manuel Castells: network society.
- Digital sociology researchers: study platforms, data and digital inequality.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Access divide	who has devices/connectivity	internet availability
Skills divide	ability to use technology	digital literacy
Outcome divide	who gains benefits	education or income

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

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3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

How do groups mobilize for social change?

CORE EXPLANATION

Social movements coordinate sustained collective action around shared claims. Mobilization depends on networks, resources, identities, political opportunities and framing of problems.

- Globalization links local life to transnational flows of goods, people, information and institutions.
- Media and digital technologies can expand connection while reproducing inequalities.
- Social movements mobilize identities, networks and resources around claims for change.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Charles Tilly: collective action and repertoires.
- Alberto Melucci: collective identity in new social movements.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Resource	money, skills or organization	volunteer network
Frame	interpretation of problem	public message
Repertoire	recognized form of action	petition or demonstration

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

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3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

How should development be measured?

CORE EXPLANATION

Development includes economic production but also health, education, security, capabilities, institutions and environmental sustainability. Sociologists study who benefits from change and how local institutions shape outcomes.

- Globalization links local life to transnational flows of goods, people, information and institutions.
- Media and digital technologies can expand connection while reproducing inequalities.
- Social movements mobilize identities, networks and resources around claims for change.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Amartya Sen: capability approach.
- Immanuel Wallerstein: world-systems analysis.
- Development sociologists: study institutions and livelihoods.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Income growth	economic expansion	GDP per person
Human development	health and education	life expectancy and schooling
Capability	real opportunity to do and be	access plus freedom

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

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3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

Why is it misleading to treat Africa as one social model?

CORE EXPLANATION

African societies contain immense linguistic, religious, economic, political and cultural diversity. Sociological analysis should use specific countries, regions and institutions rather than broad stereotypes.

- Globalization links local life to transnational flows of goods, people, information and institutions.
- Media and digital technologies can expand connection while reproducing inequalities.
- Social movements mobilize identities, networks and resources around claims for change.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- African sociologists: analyze urbanization, family, work, religion, inequality and postcolonial change across diverse settings.
- W. E. B. Du Bois: connected global race and colonial questions.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Diversity	many social contexts	languages and institutions
Urban change	rapid city growth	new labor and housing patterns
Transnational ties	migration and remittances	family networks across borders

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

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5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

How can sociology study social change in Madagascar?

CORE EXPLANATION

A sociological approach to Madagascar can examine urban growth, rural livelihoods, education, family networks, informal work, migration, associations and cultural continuity. Local evidence is essential because conditions differ across regions and communities.

- Globalization links local life to transnational flows of goods, people, information and institutions.
- Media and digital technologies can expand connection while reproducing inequalities.
- Social movements mobilize identities, networks and resources around claims for change.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Local and regional social researchers: study livelihoods, institutions and community change in Malagasy contexts.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Urban setting	dense services and employment	Antananarivo and other cities
Rural livelihood	land and agriculture connections	farming communities
Social network	family and association support	mutual aid and information

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
2. Answer the guiding question in 3-4 sentences.
3. Give one real or hypothetical example.
4. Compare two sociological approaches or concepts.
5. State one limitation or question for further research.

GUIDING QUESTION

Which social changes are likely to matter most?

CORE EXPLANATION

Sociology does not predict one fixed future. It analyzes how demographic change, technology, climate risk, education, work, migration and institutions may interact under different conditions.

- Globalization links local life to transnational flows of goods, people, information and institutions.
- Media and digital technologies can expand connection while reproducing inequalities.
- Social movements mobilize identities, networks and resources around claims for change.

KEY THINKERS / APPROACHES

- Contemporary sociologists: use comparative evidence and scenarios to study emerging social transformations.

COMPARE THE CONCEPTS

Concept	Meaning	Example
Demographic change	aging or youth population	service demand
Technological change	automation and platforms	new work forms
Environmental change	climate and resource pressures	migration and adaptation

KEY TERMS

APPLICATION

CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

1. Define two key terms from this lesson.
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BIG QUESTIONS ACROSS THE COURSE

Structure & agency	How do institutions shape choices?	school, labor market, family
Culture	How are meanings learned and contested?	norms, values, identity
Institutions	How are recurring social needs organized?	family, education, economy
Inequality	Why are resources and opportunities unequal?	class, gender, race/ethnicity
Deviance	How are rules created and enforced?	labeling, strain, control
Population	How do births, deaths and migration reshape society?	demography, cities
Globalization	How do distant processes affect local life?	trade, media, migration
Social change	How do institutions transform over time?	technology, movements, development

THREE CORE PERSPECTIVES

- Functionalism: asks how institutions contribute to order, integration and continuity, while also considering dysfunctions.
- Conflict approaches: ask how resources and power are distributed and how inequality creates competing interests.
- Interactionism: asks how meanings, identities and social realities are produced through everyday interaction.
- Strong sociology can combine levels rather than forcing every question into one perspective.

REVISION TASKS

Choose one institution and analyze it with all three perspectives.
Connect one micro example to a macro structure.
Explain one case where culture and inequality interact.
Define 15 terms without looking at the book.

KEY TERMS

social structure: relatively durable pattern of social relationships and positions
agency: capacity of people to act and make choices within social conditions
institution: enduring system of roles, norms and practices organized around a social need
inequality: unequal distribution of resources, opportunities, status or power
social change: transformation of institutions, relationships, norms or culture over time

A STRONG SOCIOLOGY ESSAY

- 1. Define the central concept and identify the exact question.
- 2. State the sociological perspective or mechanism.
- 3. Use at least one theorist accurately.
- 4. Apply the theory to a concrete social example.
- 5. Present an alternative explanation or limitation.
- 6. Conclude by answering the question with evidence-based reasoning.

A STRONG RESEARCH DESIGN

- 1. Write a focused research question.
- 2. Identify the population and key concepts.
- 3. Choose a method suited to the question.
- 4. Explain sampling and access.
- 5. Address consent, confidentiality and possible harm.
- 6. Discuss reliability, validity and limits to generalization.

SAMPLE ESSAY PLAN

- Question: To what extent does education reduce social inequality?
- Define education and inequality; distinguish access, attainment and outcomes.
- Functionalist view: skills, shared norms and role allocation.
- Conflict view: unequal resources, cultural capital and credential effects.
- Interactionist contribution: expectations, labeling and classroom interaction.
- Conclusion: education can create mobility, but effects depend on wider inequalities and institutional design.

COMMAND WORDS

Define: give precise meaning.

Explain: show how or why.

Compare: similarities and differences.

Assess: weigh evidence and limitations.

Discuss: present and evaluate multiple views.

PRACTICE

Plan an essay on socialization.

Design a survey on school experience.

Design an interview study on youth employment.

Write one limitation for each method.

SECTION A - SHORT ANSWERS

- Define sociology, social structure, socialization, institution and inequality.
- Distinguish correlation from causation.
- Explain one difference between functionalism and conflict theory.
- Give two agents of socialization and explain their role.
- Define social mobility and give one example.
- Explain labeling theory in deviance.
- Define urbanization and one social consequence.
- Explain the digital divide.

SECTION B - ESSAYS

- "Social institutions create both order and inequality." Discuss.
- "Education is a major route to social mobility." Assess.
- "Deviance is created as much by social reaction as by behavior." Discuss.
- "Globalization increases connection but not equal opportunity." Assess.

ANSWER GUIDE - CORE POINTS

- Social structure refers to durable patterns of positions and relationships; agency is capacity to act within conditions.
- Correlation is association; causation requires evidence that one factor contributes to change in another.
- Functionalism emphasizes integration and functions; conflict theory emphasizes power and unequal interests.
- Socialization occurs through family, school, peers, media, workplaces and other agents.
- Mobility is movement between social positions; it can be upward, downward, intergenerational or intragenerational.
- Labeling theory examines how social reaction and stigma can shape identity and future opportunity.
- Urbanization concentrates population and can alter jobs, housing, networks and inequality.
- Digital inequality includes access, skills and unequal outcomes from technology.

CLASSIC AND INTRODUCTORY SOURCES

- Comte, Auguste - early positivist sociology and social order/change.
- Durkheim, Emile - The Division of Labour in Society; The Rules of Sociological Method; Suicide.
- Marx, Karl - selected writings on class, labor and capitalism.
- Weber, Max - Economy and Society; The Protestant Ethic and the Spirit of Capitalism.
- Du Bois, W. E. B. - The Philadelphia Negro; The Souls of Black Folk.
- Mead, George Herbert - Mind, Self, and Society.
- Goffman, Erving - The Presentation of Self in Everyday Life; Stigma.
- Merton, Robert K. - Social Theory and Social Structure.
- Becker, Howard - Outsiders.
- Bourdieu, Pierre - Distinction; writings on capital, habitus and education.
- Giddens, Anthony - Sociology and writings on structuration and modernity.
- Castells, Manuel - The Rise of the Network Society.
- Sen, Amartya - Development as Freedom.
- Mills, C. Wright - The Sociological Imagination.

SOURCE NOTE

This coursebook is an educational synthesis. Theories are simplified for introductory study and should be checked against primary texts and current empirical research for advanced work. Examples are illustrative rather than claims about every society. Sociological analysis should distinguish evidence, interpretation and value judgments.

FINAL CHECKLIST

- Use key terms accurately.
- Connect individual experience with wider social patterns.
- Compare theories fairly before evaluation.
- Choose research methods that fit the question.
- Avoid stereotypes and unsupported generalizations.
- Use evidence and acknowledge limitations.

END OF SOCIOLOGY COURSEBOOK

Understand society by connecting evidence, institutions, interaction and change.

80 / 80